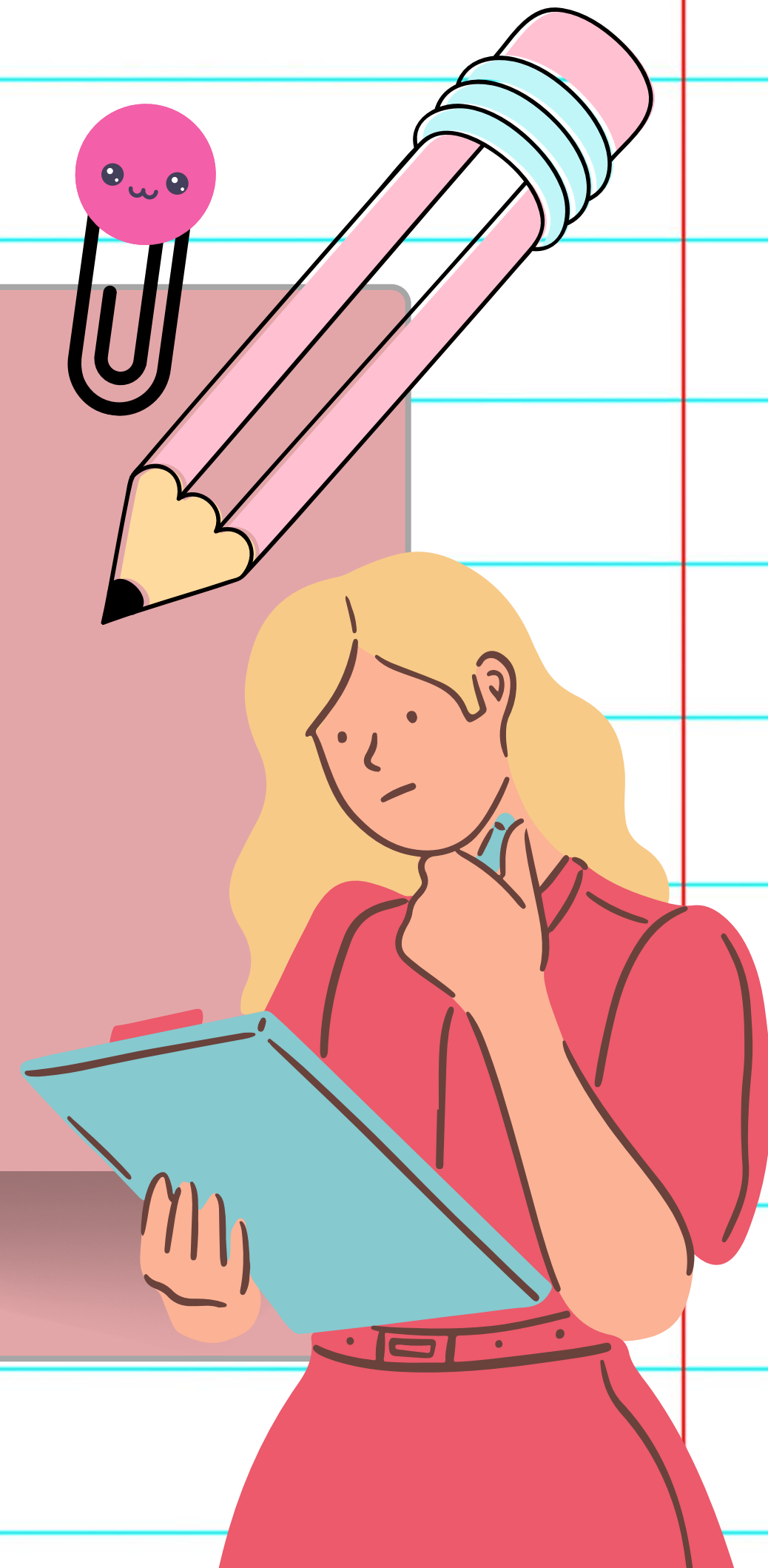
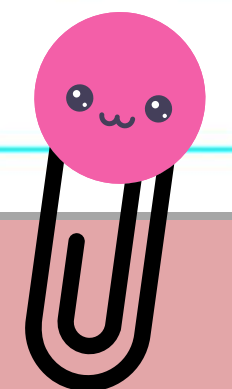
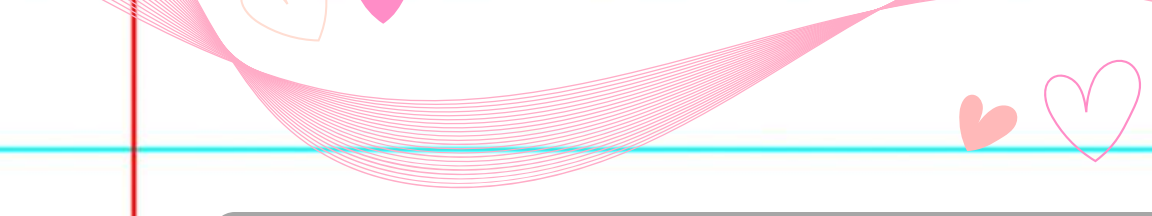


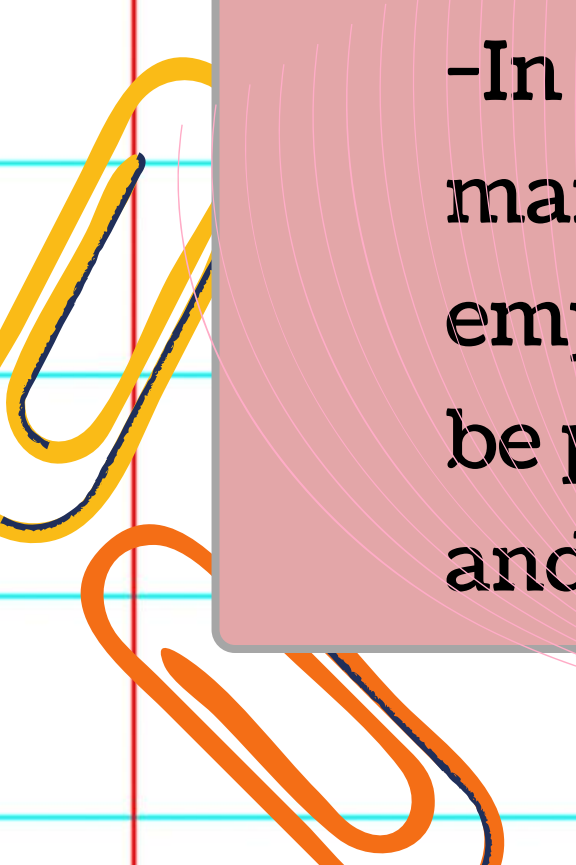
CHAPTER 4

MICE PLANNING

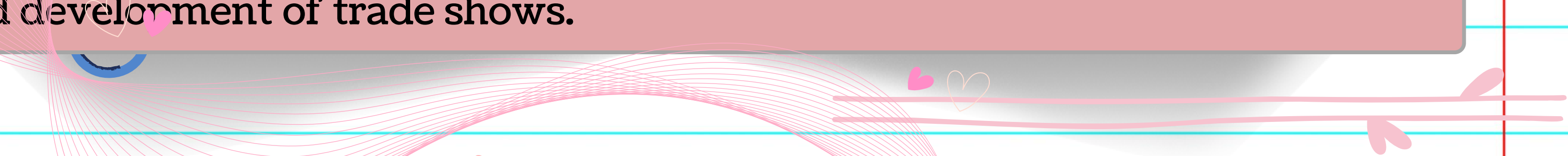


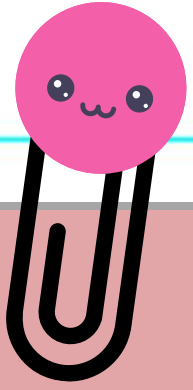


-Sponsors of MICE are responsible for determining whether or not there is a valid need for the meeting. After justifying the need for holding the meeting, the sponsor must decide how to plan the meeting. Planning is often assigned to individuals who have little knowledge on how to plan, organize, and execute meetings.



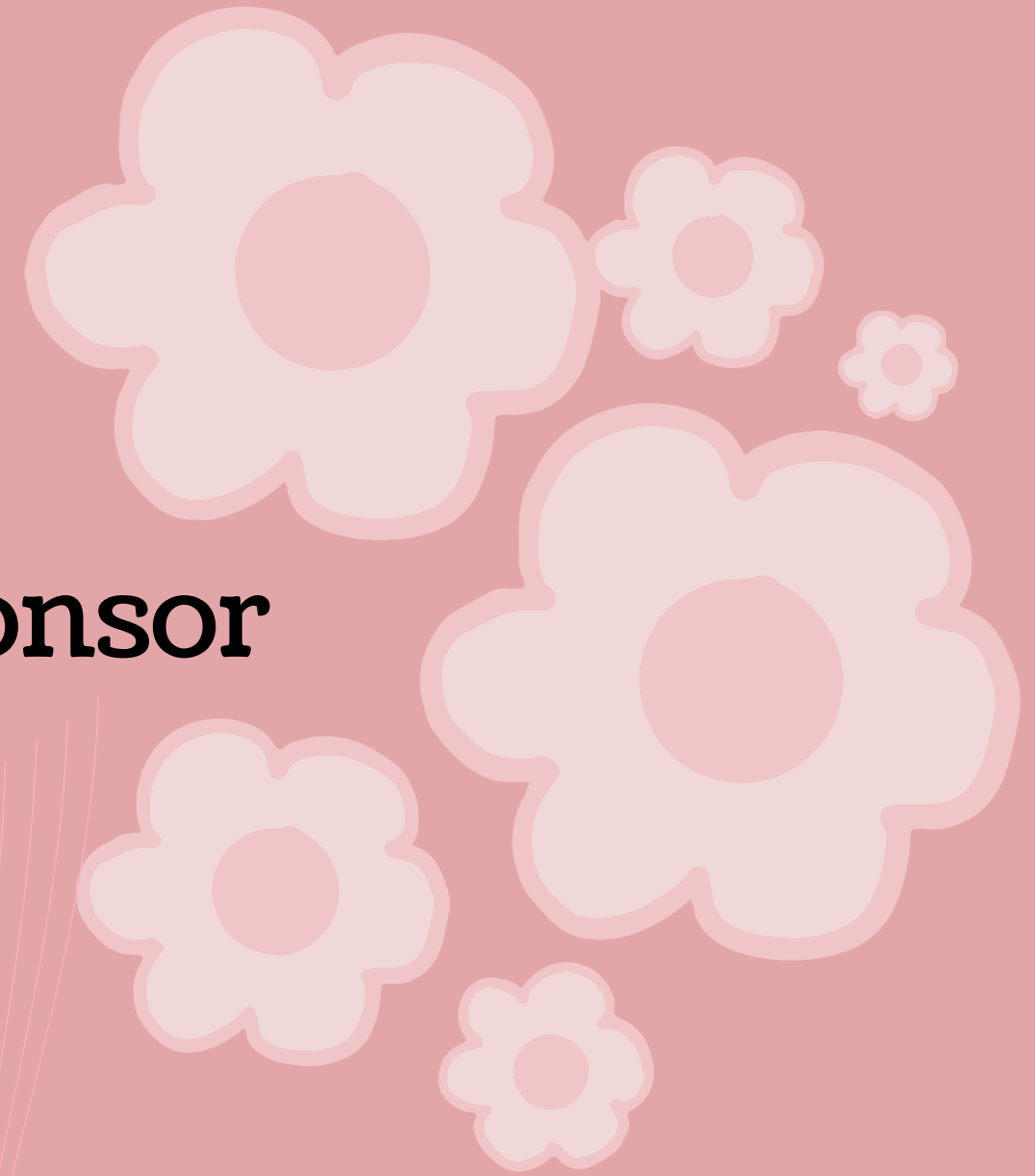
-In the case of exhibitions, sponsors either take the role of the exhibition manager or find someone to fill the position. Exhibition managers can be employees of an association or a show management company or they can be private entrepreneurs who perform tasks such as the conceptualization and development of trade shows.

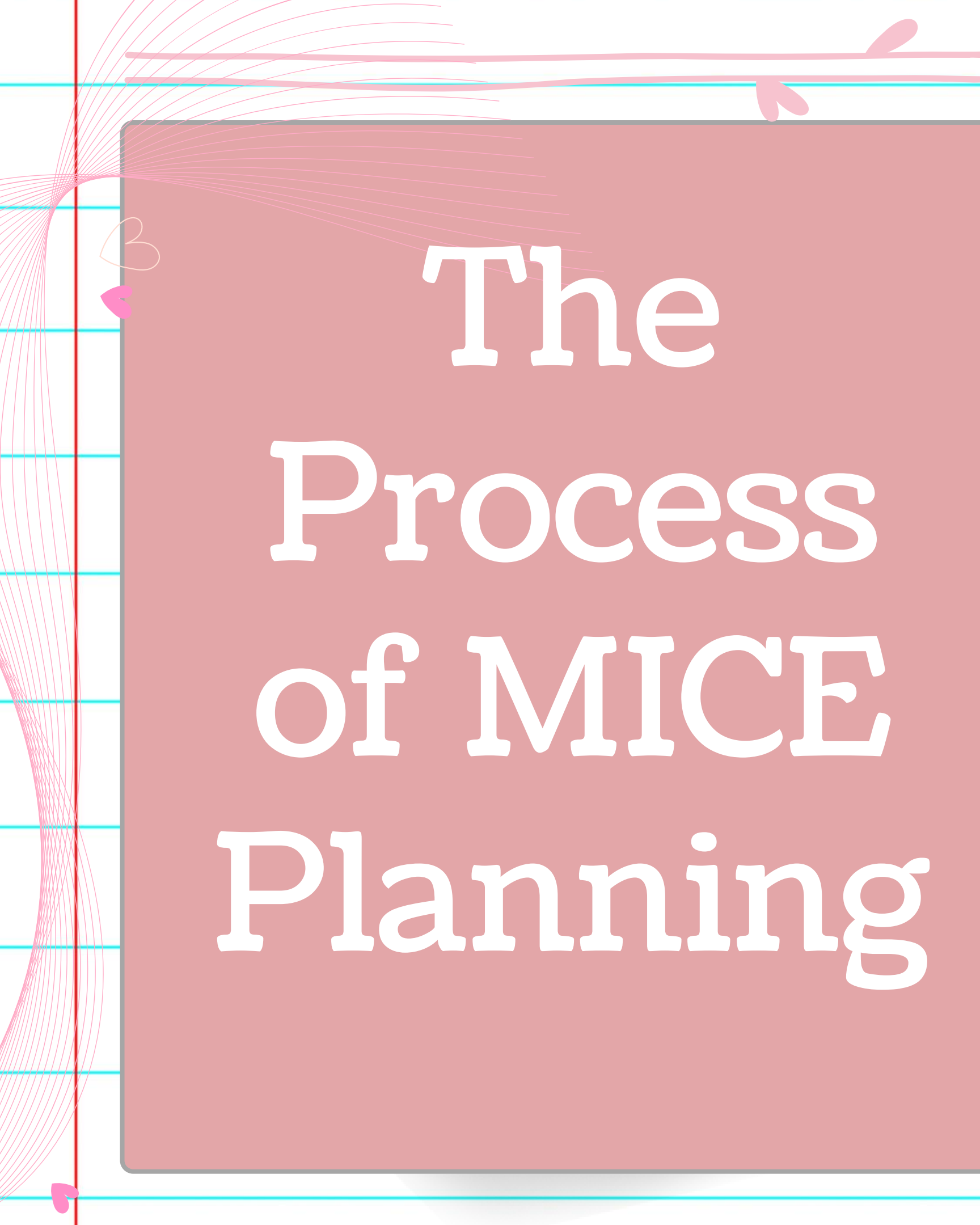




Sponsors of MICE can be:

- 1. Associations**
 - 2. Corporations**
 - 3. Trade unions**
 - 4. Independent companies who sponsor
and operate trade shows**
 - 5. Religious groups**
 - 6. Theater and arts groups**
 - 7. Social organizations**
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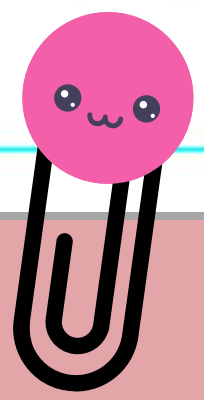




The Process of MICE Planning

These are the following:

1. Establishing goals and objectives
2. Targeting the population
3. Designing the program
4. Creating a budget
5. Selecting a site
6. Negotiating contracts
7. Formulating committees
8. Establishing a marketing and promotion plan
9. Hiring sub-contractors
10. Designing food and beverage functions



Goals and Objectives of MICE

The goals and objectives of MICE should be established by the sponsor. The MICE planner should understand whether the sponsor of the meeting or convention is interested in providing an educational experience for the attendees, entertaining the attendees and their families, boosting the morale of the attendees, solving a specific problem, or a combination of these objectives. MICE objectives should be specific, measurable, achievable, realistic, and timed (SMART).

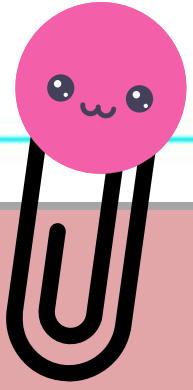
A pink paperclip with a smiling face, holding a pink paper.



Designing the Program

The program design is the structuring, balancing, and pacing of the program by combining major topics and sub-topics, passive and active sessions, and serious and fun presentations to provide professional and personal growth, and networking opportunities for participants.





Hospitality Programs/Spousal Programs

- The programs for guests of conference participants are called hospitality programs or spousal programs.
 - These programs are designed to entertain the guests of the conference attendees.
 - These programs usually have an extensive itinerary that keeps the participants busy. Hospitality programs increase attendance at conferences. They also increase revenue for the host property because guests of attendees eat in the restaurant, shop in the stores, and use other services offered by the host facility.
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Hospitality Programs/Spousal Programs

-For this reason, many host properties include in their bids hospitality programs designed to entertain conference attendees and their guests. In addition to the meeting planner and the association executives, the host property should take an active role in the planning of a hospitality program.

After the historical review, the meeting planner and the host property should survey the participants to determine the likes and dislikes of the group.

The survey will include the following areas:

1. Hobbies
2. Sports they enjoy
3. Ages of the participants
4. Gender of the participants



Design of Hospitality Programs

Planned social activities for hospitality programs include the following:

1. Tours
2. Plays
3. Concerts
4. Sporting events
5. Tournaments
6. Guest speakers
7. Shopping trips
8. Demonstrations
9. Cooking lessons
10. Craft activities
11. Movies



-These activities are chosen based on the interest of the group as well as the budget for the hospitality program. The primary goal of the hospitality program is to make the participants feel comfortable, well cared for, and anxious to return.

BUDGET

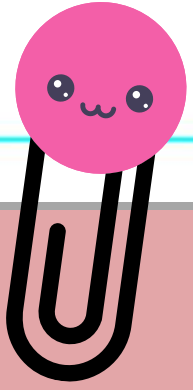
-According to P.C. Dotson, a budget is an estimate of income and expenses and a plan to adjust the anticipated expenses to the expected income. A budget includes fixed expenses, variable expenses, and sources of revenue.

-Fixed expenses are not dependent on the number of attendees.

-Variable expenses are those that fluctuate depending on the number of attendees.

- Sources of revenue to support the activities must be developed. Registration fees are the most constant source of income for conferences. Other sources of revenue are advertising, educational material from the event, sponsorship, grants, company funding, and soon.





♥ SITE SELECTION

- The site selection process is a significant activity of the sponsoring organization. Convenience and cost are very important in site selection.
 - The planner must first determine the aims of the meeting, convention, and exhibition. Thus, a group prospectus is made to help the MICE planner to know the physical requirements for the meeting, convention, and exhibition.
 - The MICE planner should bring a checklist during the site selection. The checklist includes the following areas: sleeping rooms, meeting and exhibition space, transportation (airport and ground), food and beverage, recreation (on-site and local attractions), and services.
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Room Setup and Layout

In order to meet the requirements of clients, it is important that the venue has the necessary amount of space and the proper type of space to service the conferences or meetings.

1. Theater or auditorium setup - it is the most functional seating arrangement especially when the meeting involves a large group of participants. It involves placing chairs in rows, either straight or in a semicircle. Chairs should be placed 4 to 6 inches apart, with approximately 2 1/2 feet from the back of one chair to the front of the chair behind it. This setup is suitable for lecture-type meetings.



The following are the different kinds of room setups:

2. **Schoolroom or classroom setup** - it is conducive to participants taking notes, reading materials, or working on projects. It is suitable for small lectures and workshops where note-taking is required.



3. **Hollow square, U-shape, and the herringbone layout** - these setups are suitable for board meetings, management meetings, and small group discussions. The main advantage is they encourage discussions and interaction among participants.



4. **Banquet or round table layout**- This layout is suitable for banquets, seminars, and round table discussions. The advantages are it can be used when meetings break up into smaller discussion groups without participants having to exchange rooms, and it can accommodate food and beverage service comfortably.



Hiring Sub-contractors - Technical Transportation



-Because a large part of its budget is allotted to transportation, there are two issues that need to be considered. First, the planner should determine how to transport the participants to the host city where the meeting is to be held.

Second, the planner should determine how to transport them from one place to another within the host city. The planner must also determine how to transfer the exhibit materials, office supplies, and registration materials to the exhibit site.

Negotiations

-Negotiations are held between the representative of the host property and the sponsoring organization.

Examples of negotiable areas are sleeping rooms, function space, safety, security, accessibility, food and beverage, renovation and construction, contingencies, restrictions, and cancellations.

-A contract is written and signed after the negotiations have concluded. A contract is a legal document that explains the responsibilities of the concerned parties.

Formulating Committees

♥ The formulation of committees is essential in sponsoring a meeting, convention, or exhibition. Each committee must have its own aims. If a professional association is the sponsor of the conference, the association is authorized by its constitution to form a committee that will plan, organize, and operate the conference. Each committee should have a chairman.



Marketing and Promotion

♥ The following should be determined in order to ensure a successful conference:

1. Know the number of break-even attendance
2. Establish a marketing plan
3. Establish a timetable
4. Carry out the program
5. Appraise the program



On-site Management



On-site management involves overseeing every aspect of the meeting or convention from the time the registration table opens until the last guest departs. For large meetings that last several days, one person cannot attend every activity. The planner should arrive a few days before the event to meet with the hotel staff, suppliers, personnel, and other key individuals.

-This pre-convention meeting allows all parties to understand their needs during the event. Price recommends that the pre-convention meeting should include each department that has specific responsibilities during the meeting, such as the front desk, accounting, security, electrician, and bell staff.

On-site Management

-The planner should make sure that all employees are at their assigned areas, pick up messages regularly from the staff office, and maintain regular communication with the suppliers and personnel.

-The planner must also monitor the on-site attendance. It is important to know how many people attend each function.

-The planner should also conduct a post-conference meeting to evaluate the meeting-its strengths and weaknesses.





Evaluation

A meeting has to be evaluated in order to ascertain whether the goals that were established during the conceptualization phase were realized.

There are several ways of evaluating meetings. Smaller meetings can be evaluated through informal methods. Comment cards and informal conversations with the planner can be used to obtain general feedback. After the meeting, the sponsor or planner may contact some attendees and ask their impressions of the event.



♥ Evaluation

- Another method is a focus group which may give suggestions for improvement such as questionnaires or surveys are other ways of evaluating the meeting or convention. Questionnaires should be short and easy to understand.
- To increase the return rate, questionnaires should be designed in such a way that it can be easily and quickly completed. Thorough evaluation makes poor programs good and good programs excellent (Teurgens, 2000).